

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1203

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Charles Edward Bottens on the celebration of his 100th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Charles Edward Bottens will celebrate his 100th birthday on June 7, 2026, a milestone that will be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected member of the Brentwood community, Charles Bottens was born on June 7, 1926, and was reared during the Great Depression; he began his working life at the age of sixteen on a dairy farm and later contributed to the war effort during World War II through employment with a company manufacturing aircraft cables; and

WHEREAS, a member of this nation's "Greatest Generation," Mr. Bottens served with valor in the United States Army during World War II, having been drafted in September 1944 and deployed to the Pacific Theater; and

WHEREAS, during his military service, he participated in operations in the Philippines, including on the islands of Cebu, Leyte, and Negros; in recognition of his contributions to the liberation of the Philippines, he was awarded the Bronze Star; and

WHEREAS, Charles Bottens continued his service with the 8th Army Headquarters following the conclusion of World War II, serving in the Military Police in Yokohama, Japan, during the occupation, and was honorably discharged in 1947 with the rank of Sergeant; and

WHEREAS, throughout his professional career, Mr. Bottens was employed by Sunbeam Corporation and later owned and operated a service station; he also spent many years as a truck driver, hauling steel, industrial gases, and other commodities and earning the respect and admiration of his colleagues for his strong work ethic and dedication; and

WHEREAS, following his retirement, he moved from Illinois to Florida and served his community by volunteering at the Cape Coral Hospital for twenty-one years in the transport department, moving patients throughout the hospital in wheelchairs or gurneys until COVID forced an end to the volunteer program at the hospital in 2020; and

WHEREAS, Charles Bottens was joined in holy matrimony with Elaine Zaloudek in June 1955, and they were blessed with two daughters, Cynthia and Laura; the couple shared sixty-five years of marriage until her passing in 2020; and

WHEREAS, as Mr. Bottens celebrates his 100th birthday, he remains a source of inspiration to his family and community, embodying the values of perseverance, service, and devotion that define his generation; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Charles Edward Bottens on the celebration of his 100th birthday and extend to him our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.